

Motivation Letter – Orientation Year Residence Permit (Zoekjaar)

Dear Sir/Madam,

My name is Purvish Prakash Shah, and I am applying for the Orientation Year (Zoekjaar) Residence Permit to pursue the next stage of my career in the Netherlands. As an experienced Software Developer, Full Stack Engineer, and AI Engineer with over eight years of professional experience, I have built my career around developing scalable software solutions, backend systems, and AI-driven applications. Combined with an internationally recognised postgraduate education, I am eager to contribute my expertise to one of Europe's most innovative and technology-driven economies.

I graduated in November 2023 with an MSc in Computer Science from University College Dublin (UCD), Ireland. At the time of my studies, UCD was ranked 173rd globally in the QS World University Rankings, while my **Computer Science programme was ranked 151st worldwide**. Today, UCD has further strengthened its global reputation by ranking 100th globally and 38th in Europe in the latest QS World University Rankings. Studying at such a globally recognised institution equipped me with advanced technical knowledge, research skills, and an international perspective that continues to shape my professional career.

Over the course of my career, I have gained more than eight years of experience in software development, backend engineering, full-stack development, and Artificial Intelligence. I worked for over four years at Barclays as a Software Developer, where I developed enterprise-scale software solutions and contributed to large, complex technology projects. Following my master's degree, I have been working with Pixelcut, a US-based AI company, as a Full Stack Developer and AI Engineer, building AI-powered applications while continuously expanding my expertise in modern software engineering and emerging technologies.

The Netherlands has always been the country where I envision building the next stage of my career. Renowned for its world-class technology ecosystem, innovation-driven economy, and leadership in Artificial Intelligence and digital transformation, it offers the ideal environment for experienced technology professionals. With over eight years of experience in software development, backend engineering, and AI, I am confident that my skills align strongly with the evolving needs of the Dutch technology sector. I look forward to contributing to innovative organisations while continuing to grow professionally in one of Europe's most forward-thinking economies.

The Orientation Year programme presents an excellent opportunity to apply my skills within the Dutch labour market while continuing to grow professionally. Beyond contributing through innovation and technical expertise, I look forward to becoming an active member of Dutch society by working, collaborating with international teams, contributing to economic growth through skilled employment and taxation, and building a long-term career in the Netherlands. I have also started learning about Dutch culture and the Dutch language to integrate more effectively into both the workplace and the local community.

I am excited by the opportunity to live and work in the Netherlands, contribute to its thriving technology sector, and build my future in a country renowned for innovation, openness, and technological excellence.

Thank you for considering my application. I would be grateful for the opportunity to participate in the Orientation Year programme and contribute positively to the Netherlands through my technical expertise, international education, and professional experience.

Yours sincerely,
Purvish Prakash Shah